

healing TOUCH

✱ Institute of Kidney Diseases and Research Centre

Project Cadaver kidney transplant programme

Fast Relief 30 minutes is all it took for the doctors here to remove a donor's kidneys in 13 such cases

A kidney transplant costs Rs 1.5 lakh. However, if cadaver kidneys are used, the cost can come down to Rs 10,000.

It has done the highest number of kidney transplants in the country, 193 at the last count, but that's not the only feather in the cap of this research centre in Ahmedabad. It is the only one in the country that has been able to create an elaborate awareness programme, building an effective network of donors and recipients. And by doing so, the Institute

Kidney Diseases and Research Centre (IKDRC) has been able to show a way out of the kidney racket that have made a mockery of medical ethics. Architect of the institute's successful cadaver kidney transplant programme Dr H.L. Trivedi believes, "The kidney needs of the country can be met from cadavers if we, as a society, have the will." Its programme has won praise from eminent

experts like liver transplant surgeon and former chairman of the Nobel Peace Committee Carl-Gustav Groth, and the inventor of tissue typing technology Paul Terasaki for its precision and cutting-edge speed.

An autonomous body backed by Gujarat Government, the institute has been able to raise a cadaver harvesting team of doctors, nurses and even peons. The team rushes to any part of the state on a cadaver call with the surgical equipment, harvests the kidney, brings it back and then transplants it on a recipient. In the meantime, a cadaver coordinator at IKDRC gets the blood group of the potential donor on the phone and accordingly calls six registered recipients of that particular blood group to the hospital. A carrier with a blood sample from the donor reaches the institute before the team, so that the lymphocytes of the recipients can be matched. By the time the donors are shortlisted, the team reaches the hospital and the transplant is carried out immediately, saving a lot of time. Says Dr Pranjal Modi, "It's a skilful job in which each team member has to work with great finesse." In 13 cases, the doctors of the institute were able to remove a donor's kidney within 30 minutes of his death and transplant it within the next 24 hours.

IKDRC has been successful in getting its message across as the number of recipients in its list has been increasing over the years. As part of its awareness programme, IKDRC held its first cadaver awareness conference for local doctors, NGOs and paramedical staff in 2005, where they were trained in motivating potential donors and becoming cadaver donors. A life-size portrait of a kidney at the meeting sent a strong message, "Don't burn or bury me. Keep me for a waiting patient so that I can save one more life". Indeed, the institute has saved many of them. **by Uday Mahur**

MIRACLE CURE:
Trivedi



SHAILESH RAVAL

An effective cadaver kidney transplant programme is the only way to solve our problems on this front.

DR H.L. TRIVEDI, Director, IKDRC